

Job Thing

A dedicated, one-handed device for triaging SDET and QA job postings

JobThing



Owner

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Status

Shipped, in daily use

Version

1.0 · September 2026

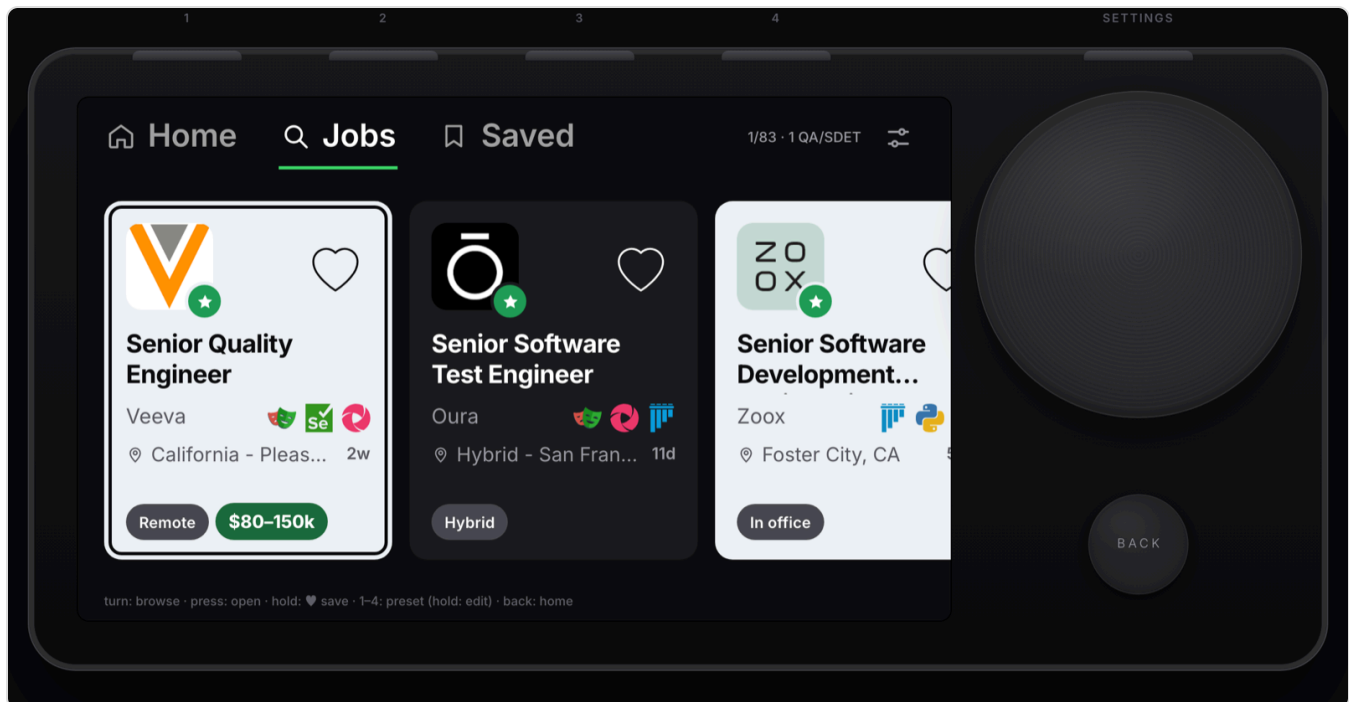
Links

jobthing.vercel.app

1 Summary

Job Thing turns a jailbroken Spotify Car Thing (an 800x480 touchscreen with a dial and five buttons) into a job board for one kind of role: software quality engineering. Once an hour a small server on the owner's computer pulls every open posting from about 90 company job boards, keeps only the QA, SDET and test infrastructure roles, ranks them against the owner's resume, and serves them to the device. The owner turns the dial through the cards, presses to read a posting and presses again to save it. Saved jobs can be opened on the computer or prepared as applications that the owner reviews and submits.

A public web demo runs the same kiosk UI inside an emulator, on a daily snapshot of real postings, so anyone can try it without the hardware.



The public demo. Each card shows only what the decision needs: company, title, tools, location, age, work mode and posted pay.

2 Problem

- **The good postings are scattered.** Most tech companies publish openings on their own Greenhouse, Lever or Ashby board. Checking dozens of boards by hand does not happen every day, so new roles get seen late.

- **Aggregators are noisy for this role.** "Quality" matches manufacturing quality, food safety and search quality. "Test engineer" at a hardware company is a lab role. Reposts and stale listings bury the new ones, and pay is rarely visible at a glance.
- **A browser tab invites drift.** Job searching in a tab competes with email, news and everything else. Triage works better as a short, deliberate habit on a device that does one thing.

3 Goals and non-goals

Goals

1. Answer "which new QA and SDET roles are worth my time today" in under two minutes.
2. Show only roles that are actually software quality work, with no false positives in the top of the feed.
3. Put the deciding facts on the card: work mode, pay, level, tools, age.
4. Make every control reachable with one hand on the dial and buttons.
5. Let anyone try it in a browser, on real data, with no install.

Non-goals

- Submitting applications. Job Thing prepares; a person reviews and presses Submit.
- Scraping sites that have no public feed (LinkedIn and similar).
- Accounts, sign-in or multi-user support.
- Role families outside quality engineering.
- Sending the owner's data to any third party. The device never touches the internet.

4 Users

User	Need	Surface
Owner (a senior SDET job seeker)	A daily, trustworthy shortlist ranked against their own resume, plus a fast path from "saved" to "applied".	Car Thing on the desk; server on their computer
Demo visitor (QA engineers, hiring managers)	Try the device, browse current QA roles, take away a checklist of the ones they liked.	jobthing.vercel.app
Code reader	See how it is built and tested, and trust the tests are real.	The code and the CI test report, shared on request

5 User journeys

Morning triage (owner)

1. The device is already on and current; the server refreshed within the last hour.
2. Press preset 1 (for example, remote QA/SDET roles). The feed shows best match first, or newest first if set.
3. Turn the dial through the cards. A star on the logo marks a strong match (score 80+).
4. Press to open a posting; the dial scrolls the text smoothly. Press again to save, back to return.
5. Later, on the computer: open all saved jobs in the browser, or run Apply with Claude to prepare tailored applications for review.

Demo visit

1. The emulator boots on the logo, then lands on Jobs.

2. Arrow keys, scroll, drag or clicks drive the dial and buttons; hints explain the controls.
3. Save a few roles, then choose "Open all on your computer" to export a checklist PDF with links to each posting.

6 Requirements

P0 required for launch · **P1** shipped soon after · **P2** nice to have

ID	Feature	Requirement	Pri
F1	Sources	Fetch every open posting from public Greenhouse, Lever, Ashby and SmartRecruiters boards, plus Adzuna and Remotive, hourly. Remove postings that close. Never fetch from the device.	P0
F2	Role matching	Classify by title into testing, test infrastructure, AI evaluation and hardware test, with exclusions for non-software quality work.	P0
F3	Feed	Horizontal card rail, one detent per card, one card per role even when posted in several cities.	P0
F4	Card	Company logo (sharp at 80px or a letter), title, up to three tool logos, location, posting age, work mode and pay pills, strong-match star.	P0
F5	Posting view	Readable posting with skills, match reasons and smooth dial scrolling; press to save.	P0
F6	Presets	Four hardware buttons, each a saved mix of role, location, level and company. Each option shows how many jobs it would leave. Stored on the server.	P0
F7	Ranking	Explainable 0 to 100 score from title fit, seniority, resume skills, location and freshness. Order by best match or newest.	P0
F8	Saved	List saved jobs with status; open all on the computer; mark applied.	P0
F9	Settings	Presets, order, per-source on/off with health and counts, refresh now, status.	P1
F10	Home trends	Per-preset market summary: new in 24h and 7 days, remote share, median pay, top companies, most requested skills versus the resume.	P1
F11	Location groups	Remote, US metros, Outside US and regions (Canada, UK, Europe, LatAm, APAC, UAE, Dubai) from free-text locations.	P1
F12	Apply with Claude	Tailor the resume from verified facts only, fill the form in Chrome, stop before Submit. Never sign in, create accounts or answer self-identification questions.	P1
F13	Web demo	Same UI in an emulator on a daily snapshot; visitor state stays in their browser; checklist PDF export.	P1
F14	Screenshots	Dial plus preset 1 saves exactly what the panel shows.	P2
F15	Private boards	Extra boards in a local, untracked file, used on the device and never published in the demo.	P2

7 Constraints

Constraint	Impact on the product
Chromium 69 (2018)	No modern JS or CSS conveniences. The UI is plain ES2017 with no build step.
512 MB RAM, earlyoom	The system kills the browser first under memory pressure. Keep the page small, paginate on the server, stop the stock Spotify app.
800x480 panel, 60 Hz	Cards carry at most two pills and three tool logos. Scrolling targets steady 60 fps, the panel's limit.
Dial and five buttons	Every screen must work with turn, press, hold and back. Touch is optional.

8 Success metrics

Metric	Target	Result
Time from pressing a preset to a saved shortlist	Under 2 minutes	Not instrumented yet
Non-software "quality" roles in a preset feed	0	Guarded by title tests built from real postings
Render time per dial detent on the device	Under 16 ms	272 ms before, 6 ms after
Data freshness	Device 1 hour, demo 1 day	Hourly refresh; daily demo rebuild
Automated tests on every push	All green, published	184 tests; a report with videos and coverage on every run

9 Risks

- **Board APIs change or go quiet.** Remote already ignores search. Mitigation: per-source health in Settings, retries, and pruning only after a successful fetch.
- **Matching drifts as titles change.** Mitigation: every pattern change starts with a failing test that uses a real title; scores recompute when rules change.
- **Low-quality logos make the product look cheap.** Mitigation: curated high-resolution marks and a letter avatar instead of a blurry favicon.
- **Automation overreach in applications.** Mitigation: hard stop before Submit, budget caps per run, and resume checks that reject any claim not in the master resume.

10 Future work

- A reader for Workday career sites, which host many large employers.
- Alerts on the device when a strong match appears.
- Saved-job notes and application follow-up reminders.